

“

Fashion is a form of ugliness so intolerable that we have to alter it every six months.

OSCAR WILDE, 1890

”

1831–50

1839

The registration of designs for clothing is established to help protect emerging manufacturers from pirate copies of their goods being made.

1851–54

1851

American women's rights activist Amelia Bloomer makes the bloomer trouser popular.

1851

The Great Exhibition in Crystal Palace, London, attracts millions of visitors who observe displays of fashion and style.

1855–70

1855

A dotted pattern on fabric is named "polka dot" after the polka, a popular dance.

1859

A new range of dye colours in purple-pink hues are discovered and named magenta and solferino after contemporary battles.

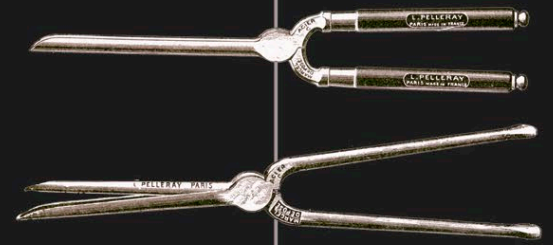
1871–80

1872

The Marcel Wave is first developed by hairdresser François Marcel, and remains popular for more than 50 years.

► Irons used for creating the Marcel Wave curling effect

1881–94



1895–1900

1845

With the arrival of the railway in the 1840s comes mass travel and clothes designed for travel, leisure, and holidays.

1852

The Englishwoman's Domestic Magazine is published, including advice on needlework from domestic writer Mrs Beeton.

▼ Bustling Regent Street outside Liberty & Co. department store in London



1882

Oscar Wilde embarks on a tour of America. His "too too and utterly utter" aesthetic fashion style is regularly remarked upon in the media.

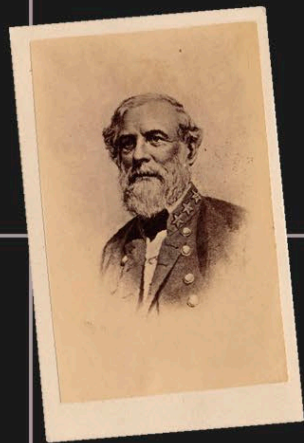
1887

Fancy Dresses Described by Arden Holt is published.

1895

The new artistic style of Art Nouveau influences fashion in the form of simple felt hats, turbans, and clouds of tulle.

▼ Playbill poster shows an actress dressed in Art Nouveau style



◀ Photography was used for fashionable visiting cards



1892

The first issue of *Vogue* magazine, founded by Arthur Turnure, is published in the United States.

1892

Viyella (a blend of wool and cotton) is introduced and is popularly used for nightwear.



1854

With the birth of photography comes the "carte de visite", a fashionable visiting card that includes a photograph of the traveller. Immense popularity leads to the publication of the cards of prominent figures, whose fashions are followed.

1869

Dolly Varden costume, named after a character in Charles Dickens's *Barnaby Rudge*, becomes a fashionable look.

▼ *Dress'd in a Dolly Varden* became a popular song

1875

Liberty & Co. department store opens in London.



1848

Known as the "Year of Revolutions" because of the series of political upheavals that take place throughout Europe, prudery reigns supreme and women's skirts are down to the ground.



1900

By the end of the century, high collars, long-line bodices, coloured tights, and high heels are fashion must-haves.

◀ Turn-of-the-century fashion looks ahead to the Edwardian era